RESEARCH FINDINGS & EXAM BLUEPRINT — NID DAT (B.Des) 2027

Research date: 7 October 2026
Prepared for: a Class 12 student taking the NID B.Des Design Aptitude Test (DAT) independently

> **How to read the labels used throughout this package**
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> - **[OFFICIAL]**: stated in an NID document (Admissions Handbook, sample paper, notification). Where I could not open the NID PDF myself, I say what I relied on.
> - **[REPORTED]**: reported by several education news sites or coaching analyses after the exam, usually from candidates' memory. Probably right, but not confirmed by NID.
> - **[TREND-BASED / INFERRED]**: my own analysis of patterns across years.
> - **[PREDICTION]**: an informed guess. It is never a guarantee.
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> **Access note (please read):** my research environment could not open `admissions.nid.edu` directly; the network proxy blocked it. Every "official" fact below comes from search-engine extracts of NID's own PDFs (the 2026-27 B.Des Handbook and the 2027-28 B.Des / Integrated Pathway Handbook), cross-checked against at least two independent education portals. **Before you rely on any date, fee or rule, check it once on https://admissions.nid.edu. NID highlights all changes there.**

1. Correct admission cycle

Item	Finding	Status
Today's date	7 Oct 2026	—
Cycle your brother is applying for	**NID Admissions 2027-28**, called "NID DAT 2027", for students joining in July/Aug 2027	[OFFICIAL] Handbook title "Admissions 2027-28 Handbook"
Why not "NID 2026"?	DAT 2026 (the 2026-27 cycle) is **finished**. Prelims were on 21 Dec 2025, Studio Test in April 2026 and In-Person Test in May 2026.	[REPORTED]
Application opened	10 Sept 2026	[OFFICIAL]
Last date to apply (online only)	**30 Nov 2026, 11:59 pm**	[OFFICIAL]
Correction window	1–3 Dec 2026	[REPORTED]
Prelims admit card	~10 Dec 2026	[REPORTED]
DAT Prelims	**Sunday, 20 December 2026**, pen-and-paper, 3 hours (last cycle ran 10:00 am–1:00 pm)	[OFFICIAL] date; timing [REPORTED]
Prelims result (B.Des)	~16 Mar 2027 (tentative)	[REPORTED]
DAT Mains	Dates to be announced after Prelims; last cycle had the Studio Test in April and the In-Person Test in May	[REPORTED]

2. What you are applying to (2027-28)

Two undergraduate routes are open through the same DAT:

1. **4-year B.Des**: at NID Ahmedabad and at the NIDs in Andhra Pradesh (Amaravati), Assam (Jorhat), Haryana (Kurukshetra) and Madhya Pradesh (Bhopal). [REPORTED, consistent with handbook extracts]
2. **NEW: 5.5-year "Professional Education Master of Design (Integrated Pathway)"**: 11 semesters, 15 sector-specific disciplines grouped under 5 design streams, at the Ahmedabad, Gandhinagar and Bengaluru campuses. Reports cite about 135 seats (15 disciplines × 9). [OFFICIAL: programme named in the 2027-28 Handbook title; seat figure REPORTED]

Seat matrix in the last cycle (2026-27), for scale: **428 B.Des seats**. Ahmedabad had 128, and AP, Assam, Haryana and MP had 75 each (25 each in Communication, Industrial, and Textile & Apparel Design), plus up to 15% supernumerary overseas seats. [OFFICIAL 2026-27; the 2027-28 matrix may differ, so check the new Handbook]

Context: the Union Budget 2026-27 proposed a **new NID in eastern India**, to be set up through a "challenge route". [REPORTED, govt budget coverage]

3. Eligibility & age (2027-28)

Category	Born on or after	Status
General / Gen-EWS (Indian)	**1 July 2006**	[REPORTED from Handbook extracts]
OBC-NCL, SC, ST	1 July 2003 (3-year relaxation)	[REPORTED]
PwD	1 July 2001 (5-year relaxation)	[REPORTED]
Overseas / foreign nationals	1 July 2006	[REPORTED]

- **Qualification:** passed, or appearing in 2026-27 for, Class 12 (10+2) in **any stream**: Science, Commerce, Arts or Vocational. No minimum percentage has been reported for B.Des. [REPORTED]
- **Application fee (B.Des):** ₹3,000 for General/EWS/OBC-NCL and ₹1,500 for SC/ST. One portal reports a lower fee for female candidates; verify this. [REPORTED: confirm on portal]

4. Exam stages & official pattern

Stage 1: DAT Prelims (shortlisting only)

What the official Handbook text says [OFFICIAL, per handbook extracts for 2026-27 and quoted again for 2027-28]:

Part	Questions	Marks
Part I: objective	Q1–14 at 1 mark each (14) + Q15–22 at 2 marks each (16)	**30**
Part II: subjective	Q23 = 15, Q24 = 20, Q25 = 15, Q26 = 20	**70**
Total	26 questions, **3 hours**	**100**, **no negative marking**

- **The Prelims score is used only to shortlist for Mains. It does NOT carry weightage into the final merit list.** [OFFICIAL: "Prelims score will not be carried forward as any weightage to the DAT Mains stage"]
- Last cycle shortlisted roughly **1.5 candidates per seat** for B.Des Mains. [REPORTED]

What actually happened in Dec 2025 (DAT 2026) [REPORTED by Careers360, Shiksha, GetMyUni and others]:

- **There was no objective / General Aptitude section.** The paper was fully subjective.
- It had **6 main questions with 2–3 sub-parts each, about 14 drawing/writing tasks** in 3 hours. Students found it lengthy rather than conceptually hard ("moderate to difficult").
- Memory-based questions include:
  - a sequential drawing of helping an elderly person who falls during a morning walk
  - sketching the items to carry when travelling with your grandmother
  - drawing a product you love and writing about it in 200 words
  - illustrating shikanji / thandai (an Indian drink)
  - designing 5 signboards for narrow streets
  - also reported: a three-storey scene, completing an everyday object, redesigning a product, a perspective drawing, a process drawing

Bottom line for 2027 [INFERRED]: the Handbook's printed scheme (22 objective + 4 subjective) and the real 2026 paper (all subjective) do **not** match. NID has the right to change the paper format. **Prepare for both.** The safe strategy is 75–80% of prep time on drawing, ideation and design thinking, with the objective skills (visual reasoning, design GK) kept warm. Those skills also feed the subjective answers: you cannot draw a good "Warli-inspired signboard" without knowing Warli.

Stage 2: DAT Mains (decides final merit)

Component	What it involves	Weight (last cycle)
Studio Sensitivity Test	Hands-on: sketching, doodling, material handling, 3D model-making with given materials (clay, paper, wire, found objects), sometimes audio-visual prompts. 2026: ~2.5 hours (9:30–12:00).	**60%** [REPORTED]
In-Person Sensitivity Test	Face-to-face interaction / interview-style assessment of awareness, communication, motivation and portfolio-type thinking	**40%** [REPORTED]

- For 2027-28, one portal says the "exact split [is] to be announced". Treat 60:40 as the most recent known split, not a confirmed one. [REPORTED]
- **Final merit = 100% Mains.** [OFFICIAL in principle, from the "Prelims not carried forward" rule]

Official syllabus

NID does not publish a topic-wise syllabus. [REPORTED by several portals; consistent with the Handbooks] The Handbook describes the test only in broad terms: design aptitude, creativity, visualisation, observation and problem-solving. Every "syllabus" in this package is therefore **[INFERRED]** from papers.

Cutoffs

NID does not publish official subject-wise cutoffs in a form I could verify. Coaching estimates for 2026 (General ~50–55, OBC ~45, SC/ST ~40 out of 100) are **[UNVERIFIED]** and are not used as targets anywhere in this package.

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5. Previous-paper trends (summary; full analysis in Volume 1 §6 and Volume 5)

Year (exam held)	Structure	Character	Source status
DAT 2019–2022	MCQ-heavy Part A (GK, visual reasoning, design awareness, some maths) + drawing Part B	GAT and CAT roughly balanced	[REPORTED]
DAT 2024 (Dec 2023)	31 Qs: Section 1 = Q1–27 MCQ (40 marks); Section 2 = Q28–31 subjective (60 marks)	easy–moderate; visual reasoning and design awareness	[REPORTED]
DAT 2025 (Dec 2024)	22 objective + 4 subjective = 100	CAT gained weight; logo identification; a poster for an orange-juice corner from a **crow's point of view**; a **neem branch overhanging two neighbours** problem; a train-related problem question	[REPORTED]
DAT 2026 (Dec 2025)	**6 subjective Qs (~14 tasks); no MCQs**	lengthy; empathy, everyday Indian life, sequence, signage, product love, food illustration	[REPORTED]
DAT 2027 (20 Dec 2026)	**Unknown.** Handbook still prints the 22+4 scheme.	Prepare for a subjective-heavy paper	[PREDICTION]

Clear long-run trend [TREND-BASED]: the paper moves away from recalling facts and towards **observation of everyday Indian life + empathy + problem-solving, communicated through quick, clear drawings and short writing.**

6. Most important topics (ranked)

1. **Scene drawing with people in perspective** (markets, streets, homes, stations, multi-storey views)
2. **Sequential / storyboard drawing** (3–6 frames showing an event or process, often with empathy: elderly people, children, accidents, help)
3. **Product redesign / problem-solving** (identify user problems, then sketch the solution with labels)
4. **Visual communication** (posters, signage, pictograms, symbols, logos, packaging) with colour and typography
5. **Memory and observation drawing** (objects, food, vehicles, an Indian context)
6. **Creative / lateral thinking** (unusual points of view such as a crow's eye or an ant's eye; "what if"; combining objects)
7. **Short descriptive or persuasive writing** (100–200 words about a product or experience)
8. **Visual reasoning** (folding, cubes, mirror images, patterns, counting): needed if Part I returns
9. **Design & cultural awareness** (Indian crafts, textiles, art forms, architecture, logos, designers)
10. **Current design affairs**: the low-probability MCQ topic, but useful for the interview

7. Most likely question categories [PREDICTION]

- **Tier A (very high):** a scene with people; a sequential story with an empathy angle; redesign or solve an everyday problem; a poster or signage set; drawing from memory plus a description
- **Tier B (high):** pictograms or symbols; packaging; unusual viewpoints; object completion or transformation; colour-scheme application; writing 150–200 words

- **Tier C (moderate):** an MCQ block (visual reasoning, logos, crafts, designers); maths-lite puzzles; current affairs

8. Major changes from older NID papers

1. **Objective GK/aptitude shrank, then vanished (in 2026).**
2. **Prelims lost its weightage** in the final merit; it is now only a gate.
3. **Questions became longer and multi-part.** Time management now decides results.
4. **Indian everyday context dominates:** grandparents, street food, narrow lanes, neighbours, trains.
5. **Writing appears alongside drawing** (justify, describe, label).
6. **A new 5.5-year Integrated Pathway** joins B.Des in 2027-28, using the same Prelims.

9. Recommended preparation priorities (for ~10 weeks to 20 Dec 2026)

Priority	Share of time	What
1	40%	Daily drawing: people, perspective scenes, objects from memory
2	20%	Ideation and problem-solving drills (timed), redesigns, posters, signage
3	15%	Full timed papers (Vol 6–10) plus self-evaluation
4	10%	Visual reasoning MCQs (Vol 4B)
5	10%	Design / culture GK (Vol 2C, 4F–G, 12)
6	5%	Current affairs (Vol 11)

10. Sources consulted (full log in `99-SOURCES-AND-SELF-AUDIT.md`)

- **Official:** NID Admissions portal https://admissions.nid.edu ; *B.Des Admissions Handbook 2026-27* (`admissions.nid.edu/NIDA2026/download/BDes_AdmissionsHandbook2026-27.pdf`) ; *Admissions 2027-28 Handbook: B.Des & 5.5-yr M.Des Integrated Pathway* (`admissions.nid.edu/NIDA2027/download/BDES_IntegratedPathway_AdmissionsHandbook2027_28.pdf`) ; *B.Des DAT Prelims Sample Test Paper* (`admissions.nid.edu/NIDA2026/download/SamplePaper_DATPrelims_BDes.pdf`)
- **Previous-paper analyses:** Careers360 (NID DAT 2026 Prelims Question Paper with Solution, Parts A/B); Shiksha (NID DAT 2026 B.Des Exam Analysis); GetMyUni (2026 analysis); Careers360 and PW (2025 analysis); Careers360 and Shiksha (2024)
- **Dates & eligibility:** PW Live (NID DAT Notification 2027), Shiksha, Toprankers, Careers360, CareerIndia
- **Current affairs:** La Biennale di Venezia, Dezeen, Domus, ArchDaily, UNESCO-based coverage, PIB / NeGD (AI Impact Summit), Serpentine Galleries

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NEXT VOLUME: Volume 1 — NID DAT Exam Guide (`01-VOL1-EXAM-GUIDE.md`)